ANTHROPOLOGY 2017 MID EXAM SOLUTION OF HARAMAYA UNIVERSITY
PREPARED BY SMART STUDY TUTORIAL

Question 1

Which of the following best describes the concept of race in anthropology?

- **a.** A biological reality with clear genetic boundaries
- **b.** A social construct with no significant biological basis
- **c.** A purely cultural phenomenon
- **d.** A fixed and unchanging category

Answer: b. A social construct with no significant biological basis

Explanation: Anthropologists view race as a category created by society to group people based on physical traits, rather than a reflection of distinct biological divisions.

Question 2

Which of the following statements is not correct about anthropology?

- **a.** Comparative perspective is essential for understanding the differences and similarities across various cultures, societies, and historical periods
- **b.** It involves mainly emphasizing macro-social processes to understand social issues.
- **c.** Anthropology studies all aspects of human beings, regardless of their cultural background, period, or level of societal development.
- **d.** Anthropology has a relativist approach and hence suggests refraining from making value judgments

Answer: b. It involves mainly emphasizing macro-social processes to understand social issues.

Explanation: Anthropology typically focuses on micro-level details and holistic perspectives of specific communities rather than primarily focusing on large-scale (macro) social processes.

Question 3

Which of the following is true about ethnography and ethnology?

- **a.** The former uses the data of the latter for theory development
- **b.** The latter involves first-hand data collection
- **c.** The former requires fieldwork and is usually descriptive
- **d.** The latter is usually synthetic and community-specific

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Answer: c. The former requires fieldwork and is usually descriptive **Explanation:** Ethnography (the former) involves direct fieldwork to describe a specific group, while ethnology uses that descriptive data to compare different cultures.

Question 4

Which one of the following is not included in non-material culture?

- **a.** Moral values that guide people's behavior in a society
- **b.** Religious beliefs passed down through generations
- **c.** A statue built to honor a historical figure
- **d.** Traditional songs and stories shared orally

Answer: c. A statue built to honor a historical figure

Explanation: Non-material culture refers to intangible things like beliefs and values. A statue is a physical, tangible object, which places it under "material culture".

Question 5

Which of the following statements correctly describes norms in a society?

- **a.** Norms are shared guidelines that dictate appropriate behavior under certain circumstances, varying in importance across cultures
- **b.** Norms are universal standards that apply equally to all cultures, ensuring consistent behavior among diverse groups.
- **c.** Norms are outdated practices that no longer hold relevance in contemporary society.
- **d.** Norms are rigid rules that govern all aspects of behavior, leaving little room for individual interpretation.

Answer: a. Norms are shared guidelines that dictate appropriate behavior under certain circumstances, varying in importance across cultures

Explanation: Norms are social expectations that guide how people act in specific situations; they change depending on the cultural context.

Question 6

When Bekele visits his friend's house, he notices that they remove their shoes before entering. Although this differs from his custom, he respects and understands it within the context of their culture. Which concept does this best illustrate?

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- **a.** Cultural relativism
- **b.** Cultural universals
- **c.** Ethnocentrism
- **d.** Xenocentrism

Answer: a. Cultural relativism

Explanation: Cultural relativism is the practice of understanding and respecting a culture's practices based on its own logic and values.

Question 7

When we say that culture is learned, what does that mean?

- **a.** A newborn child is already fully aware of the cultural norms and values of the society into which they are born.
- **b.** We are born with an inherent understanding of society's culture, as it is genetically passed down from our parents.
- **c.** Culture is directly inherited from our parents, and we automatically adopt their cultural practices and beliefs.
- **d.** Culture is not innate; instead, we are born without it and gradually acquire it through interactions with our society and upbringing.

Answer: d. Culture is not innate; instead, we are born without it and gradually acquire it through interactions with our society and upbringing.

Explanation: Culture is acquired through a lifelong process of learning and social interaction called enculturation; it is not something we are born with.

Question 8

Which of the following is incorrect regarding the development of Anthropology?

- **a.** Belief in empirical reasoning
- **b.** Western interest in studying people under colonial rule
- **c.** Darwinian theory of evolution
- **d.** Commonsense understanding of the evolutionary process

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Answer: d. Commonsense understanding of the evolutionary process **Explanation:** Anthropology developed through scientific inquiry and theories like evolution, not through simple "commonsense" ideas which are often biased or unproven.

Question 9

Which one is correct about the economic consideration of marriage?

- **a.** Bride price is a gift from the bride's family to the groom's family.
- **b.** Dowry is a payment made by the groom to the bride's parents.
- **c.** Bride service involves the groom working for the bride's family for a set period.
- **d.** All of the above are correct.

Answer: c. Bride service involves the groom working for the bride's family for a set period.

Explanation: "Bride service" is a system where a man provides labor to his wife's family as a form of marital compensation.

Question 10

Which of the following is an example of a cultural universal?

- **a.** Speaking English as a primary language.
- **b.** The existence of a family structure or kinship system.
- **c.** Wearing specific traditional clothing.
- **d.** Celebrating a specific religious holiday.

Answer: b. The existence of a family structure or kinship system.

Explanation: While the *form* of the family changes, every known human society has a system of kinship and family organization.

Question 11

The subfield of anthropology that studies the material remains of past human behavior is:

- **a.** Cultural Anthropology
- **b.** Biological Anthropology
- **c.** Archaeology
- **d.** Linguistic Anthropology

Answer: c. Archaeology

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Explanation: Archaeology reconstructs past human life by analyzing physical objects (artifacts) and structures left behind.

Question 12

Which of the following is a key feature of the "Holistic" approach in anthropology?

- **a.** Focusing only on the biological side of humans.
- **b.** Studying humans as biological, social, and cultural beings across time and space.
- **c.** Studying only modern civilizations.
- **d.** Focusing exclusively on religious beliefs.

Answer: b. Studying humans as biological, social, and cultural beings across time and space.

Explanation: Holism means looking at the "whole" human experience, integrating history, biology, language, and culture.

Question 13

What is the term for a group of people who share a common territory and a common culture?

- **a.** Community
- **b.** Society
- **c.** Ethnicity
- **d.** Race

Answer: b. Society

Explanation: A society is a group of people who live in a specific geographic area and share a common way of life or culture.

Question 14

The process of learning one's own culture from a young age is called:

- **a.** Acculturation
- **b.** Diffusion
- **c.** Enculturation
- **d.** Assimilation

Answer: c. Enculturation

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Explanation: Enculturation is the specific social process by which culture is learned and transmitted across generations.

Question 15

Which of the following is NOT a subfield of anthropology?

- **a.** Physical Anthropology
- **b.** Social Anthropology
- **c.** Linguistic Anthropology
- **d.** Sociology

Answer: d. Sociology

Explanation: While related, Sociology is a separate discipline. The four traditional subfields of anthropology are Cultural, Biological (Physical), Linguistic, and Archaeology.

Question 16

A marriage system where one man is married to more than one woman at the same time is called:

- **a.** Polyandry
- **b.** Monogamy
- **c.** Polygyny
- **d.** Endogamy

Answer: c. Polygyny

Explanation: Polygyny is a form of polygamy where a male has multiple wives simultaneously.

Question 17

Ethnocentrism refers to:

- **a.** Judging other cultures by one's own cultural standards.
- **b.** Respecting all cultures equally.
- **c.** Learning a new language.
- **d.** Moving to a different country.

Answer: a. Judging other cultures by one's own cultural standards.

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Explanation: Ethnocentrism is the tendency to view one's own culture as the "center" and superior to others.

Question 18

Which research method involves living with a community for an extended period to observe their behavior?

- **a.** Surveying
- **b.** Laboratory experimentation
- **c.** Participant observation
- **d.** Historical analysis

Answer: c. Participant observation

Explanation: This is the primary method of cultural anthropology, where the researcher takes part in the daily lives of the people being studied.

Question 19

Culture is "symbolic" because:

- **a.** It is passed down through DNA.
- **b.** It relies on shared meanings assigned to things like language or flags.
- **c.** It never changes.
- **d.** It is only found in wealthy societies.

Answer: b. It relies on shared meanings assigned to things like language or flags.

Explanation: Symbolic culture means that humans use arbitrary signs (like a word or a gesture) to represent complex ideas.

Question 20

The idea that no culture is inherently "better" than another is a core principle of:

- **a.** Cultural Relativism
- **b.** Globalization
- **c.** Ethnocentrism
- **d.** Evolutionism

Answer: a. Cultural Relativism

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Explanation: Cultural relativism argues that cultures should be evaluated based on their own internal logic rather than an external "superior" standard.

Question 21

Which of the following describes "Applied Anthropology"?

- **a.** Theoretical research with no practical use.
- **b.** Using anthropological methods to solve real-world problems.
- **c.** The study of ancient fossils only.
- **d.** The study of primates in zoos.

Answer: b. Using anthropological methods to solve real-world problems.

Explanation: Applied anthropology uses the knowledge and methods of the field to help in areas like healthcare, business, or policy-making.

Question 22

Biological (Physical) Anthropology is primarily concerned with:

- **a.** Ancient architecture.
- **b.** Human evolution and biological variation.
- **c.** Contemporary political systems.
- **d.** The history of world religions.

Answer: b. Human evolution and biological variation.

Explanation: This subfield looks at how humans have evolved over time and the biological differences among modern human populations.

Question 23

What is "Diffusion" in the context of culture?

- **a.** The birth of a new idea within a society.
- **b.** The spread of cultural traits from one society to another.
- **c.** The loss of traditional values.
- **d.** A type of marriage ritual.

Answer: b. The spread of cultural traits from one society to another.

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Explanation: Diffusion occurs when cultures come into contact and exchange ideas, technologies, or customs.

Question 24

A group that shares a specific set of cultural traits within a larger society is called a:

- **a.** Primary society
- **b.** Subculture
- **c.** Global community
- **d.** Caste system

Answer: b. Subculture

Explanation: Subcultures are smaller groups within a society that have distinctive beliefs or behaviors that set them apart from the dominant culture.

Question 25

Kinship systems are based on:

- **a.** Shared biological descent or marriage.
- **b.** Political party affiliation only.
- **c.** Professional expertise.
- **d.** Wealth and social class only.

Answer: a. Shared biological descent or marriage.

Explanation: Kinship is the web of social relationships that form an important part of the lives of all humans in all societies.

Question 26

Which of the following is true about "Values"?

- **a.** They are identical in every culture.
- **b.** They are shared ideas about what is right, desirable, or important.
- **c.** They are physical objects like tools.
- **d.** They have no influence on human behavior.

Answer: b. They are shared ideas about what is right, desirable, or important.

Explanation: Values provide the underlying logic for a society's norms and laws.

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Question 27

Medical Anthropology is a sub-discipline that bridges which two fields?

- **a.** Biology and Culture
- **b.** History and Economics
- **c.** Physics and Chemistry
- **d.** Music and Art

Answer: a. Biology and Culture

Explanation: It studies how health and illness are shaped, experienced, and understood by both biological and cultural factors.

Question 28

When a minority group adopts the patterns and norms of a dominant host culture, it is called:

- **a.** Cultural pluralism
- **b.** Assimilation
- **c.** Segregation
- **d.** Ethnocentrism

Answer: b. Assimilation

Explanation: Assimilation is the process by which a person or group's culture comes to resemble those of another group.

Question 29

What is the "Emic" perspective in anthropology?

- **a.** The perspective of an outside scientist.
- **b.** The perspective of the local people within the culture being studied.
- **c.** A perspective based only on data.
- **d.** A perspective that ignores culture.

Answer: b. The perspective of the local people within the culture being studied.

Explanation: The "emic" approach seeks to understand how local people think, perceive, and categorize the world.

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Question 30

Globalization in anthropology refers to:

- **a.** The isolation of cultures from each other.
- **b.** The increasing interconnectedness of people and societies worldwide.
- **c.** The study of only one specific village.
- **d.** The end of all cultural differences.

Answer: b. The increasing interconnectedness of people and societies worldwide.

Explanation: Globalization involves the worldwide spread of ideas, technologies, and commerce, often leading to cultural exchange and change.

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